Testicles

Testicles are part of the male reproductive system. Each testicle is a factory producing sperm, the male sex cells. Testosterone, the hormone that controls the development of male puberty, is also made in the testicles.

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How they work

Two testicles are housed in a protective pouch of skin called the scrotum. The scrotum helps keep the temperature of the testicles slightly cooler than the body's core temperature of 99°F (37°C). The testicles hang outside the body, because they produce sperm best at about 95°F (35°C). To stop them bumping into each other, it's common for one testicle to hang lower than the other. It's also perfectly normal for them not to be symmetrical.

▽ **Sperm**
Each sperm contains genetic information from the male, and its function is to move toward and fuse with an egg, the female sex cell, during sexual reproduction. Sperm live only for a few days.

▽ **Inside the testicle**
The average testicle is small, oval-shaped, and about 2 in (5 cm) in length from end to end. After puberty starts, each testicle continues making around 3,000 sperm per second, until the end of a man's life.